



**BIRLA INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY AND SCIENCE, Pilani**  
**Pilani Campus**  
**AUGS/ AGSR Division**

**First Semester 2026-2027**  
**Course Handout (Part II)**

Date: 01 August 2026

In addition to Part I (General Handout for all courses appended to the Timetable), this portion gives further specific details regarding the course.

**Course No.** : BITS F437  
**Course Title** : Technical Communication  
**Instructor-in-Charge** : GAJENDRA SINGH CHAUHAN  
**Instructors** : Gajendra Singh Chauhan and Kakoli Goswami

**1. Course Description:**

Specifically designed for HD students, this course aims to improve students' academic and professional language skills. Science and engineering contexts will be used where necessary for teaching writing and speaking skills. Technological tools like Grammarly, COCA and BAWE are also included in the course so that students can learn to be accurate in their use of English language.

**2. Scope and Objective:**

- Understand the definition, process, and barriers of communication.
- Develop effective listening, note-taking, reading, and note-making skills.
- Practice summarizing and paraphrasing for clarity and precision.
- Apply audience-aware writing style with clear purpose and organization.
- Prepare structured technical reports using appropriate data collection methods.
- Employ IMRD structure for research writing, including results, analysis, and discussion.
- Demonstrate competence in editing, oral presentation, and group discussion.
- Build professional readiness through cover letters, CVs, and interview skills.

**3. Textbook:**

Raman, M. and Sharma, S. 2015. *Technical communication: Principles and practice. 3<sup>rd</sup> Edition*. New Delhi: OUP.

**4. Reference Books:**

1. Bailey, S. (2018). *Academic writing: A handbook for international students, 5th Edition*. New York: Routledge.
2. Bottomley, J. (2022). *Academic Writing for International Students of Science (Second)*. Routledge: Taylor & Francis Group.



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3. De Chazal, E. & Moore, J. (2013). *Oxford EAP: Advanced/C1: Student's book and DVD-ROM pack*. Oxford University Press.
4. Lynch, T. (2004). *Study listening: A course in listening to lectures and note-taking*. Cambridge University Press.
5. Wilding, E. (2016). *University foundation study: Presentations (Student's Book)*. Reading: Garnet Education.
6. Swales, J. M., & Feak, C. B. (2012). *Academic writing for graduate students: Essential tasks and skills* (3rd ed.). Ann Arbor: The University of Michigan Press.

**5. Course Plan:**

| Module No. | Lecture Session                                                                             | Reference                      | Learning outcomes                                                                                                                                |
|------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1          | Introduction to the Course and the Handout Communication: Definition and Process & Barriers | Course Handout TB Ch.1, 2, & 3 | Relate process and types of general communication with technical communication<br>Understand the nuances of technical communication (case study) |
| 2 - 3      | Listening and Note-taking                                                                   | RB 4                           | Listen for comprehension, prediction, and note-taking                                                                                            |
| 4 - 6      | Reading and Note-making                                                                     | Class notes                    | Analyze the textual features of various genres, guessing the meaning from context                                                                |
| 7-8        | Summarizing and Paraphrasing                                                                | Class notes & R1               | Identify main ideas and supporting ideas, developing texts with the help of notes                                                                |
| 9-10       | Style : Audience, Purpose, and Organization                                                 | RB 2,6                         | Comparison of academic and non-academic texts to determine stylistic preferences (studying registers)                                            |
| 11 - 12    | Technical Reports: Types, Structure and Methods of Data Collection                          | TB Ch. 18                      | Understand the purpose and scope of reports<br>Understand the processes of writing technical reports                                             |
| 13 - 14    | Tool Design                                                                                 | TB Ch. 18                      | Identify and write the items to be included in the tool                                                                                          |
| 15 - 16    | IMRD Structure                                                                              | Class notes                    | Understand the use of IMRD (Introduction – Methods - Results – Discussion) across disciplines                                                    |
| 17 - 18    | Writing the Results                                                                         | Class notes                    | Write up a detailed analysis of data and connect multiple data stories together into a coherent narrative                                        |
| 19 - 20    | Report Writing                                                                              | TB Ch.18<br>Class notes        | Producing a complete technical report                                                                                                            |



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|         |                                |                  |                                                                                                                              |
|---------|--------------------------------|------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 21 - 22 | Writing Research: Introduction | Class notes      | Understand the structure and moves involved in a research introduction                                                       |
| 23 - 24 | Review of Literature           | Class notes & R6 | Understand the structure and moves involved in writing the review of literature                                              |
| 25 - 26 | Analysis and Discussion        | Class notes      | Analyze the research articles from specific disciplines and understand their approaches to writing discussion and conclusion |
| 27 - 29 | Editing your writing           | Class notes      | Use of technology to edit the thesis/ RA                                                                                     |
| 30 - 33 | Oral Presentation              | TB Ch.7          | Make an effective 3 MT presentation                                                                                          |
| 34 - 35 | Group Discussion               | TB Ch. 9         | Participate in group discussions                                                                                             |
| 36 - 37 | Cover Letter & CV              | Class notes      | Write a cover letter for a job                                                                                               |
| 38 - 40 | Interviews                     | Class notes      | Understand the dynamics of interviewing                                                                                      |
| 41 - 42 | Revision                       | Class notes      | Practice                                                                                                                     |

**6. Evaluation Scheme:**

| EC.NO. | Evaluation Component                  | Weightage % | Duration | Date & Time | Remarks<br>Open/Closed book |
|--------|---------------------------------------|-------------|----------|-------------|-----------------------------|
| 1      | Midsemester Test                      | 30          | 90 mins  |             | Closed Book                 |
| 2      | Assignments & Classroom Participation | 20+10       |          |             | Open Book                   |
| 3      | Comprehensive Examination             | 40          | 180 mins |             | Closed Book                 |

**7. Office consultation:** Email the concerns and you will be given time to discuss.

**8. Notices:** The notices concerning the course will be shared through Nalanda/ERP.

**9. Make-up Policy:**

While there is no makeup for assignments, for genuine cases upon submission of proof, the make-up will be administered for other evaluatives as per AUGSD-AGSRD rules. However, the student must contact the instructor for his approval. In these matters, IC's decision shall be final.

**10. Attendance Policy:**

**11. Minimum passing Marks criteria:**

**12. Note (if any):**

**Instructor-in-charge**  
**BITS F437**